Acme Employee Handbook

2026 edition, People Operations

Welcome

This handbook explains how we work at Acme. It applies to all full-time employees. Country addenda add local rules where the law requires them, and the addendum wins if it differs from this handbook.

Working Hours and Location

Acme core hours are 10:00 to 15:00 in your local time zone. Outside core hours you choose your schedule, as long as your team agrees on response times for urgent work.

Office-based employees work from the office on Tuesdays and Thursdays and may work remotely on the other days. Fully remote roles must be approved by the department VP and are listed as remote in the job description.

Working from another country for more than 14 days in a calendar year needs approval from People Operations, because it can create tax obligations.

Paid Time Off

Full-time employees receive 20 days of paid time off (PTO) per year. PTO increases by one day for each completed year of service, up to 25 days. Public holidays follow the calendar of the country you are employed in and do not count against PTO.

Request PTO in Workday. Absences of three days or more should be requested at least two weeks in advance. Up to 5 unused PTO days carry over to the next year and expire on March 31.

Sick Days

Employees receive 10 paid sick days per year. Tell your manager as early as possible on the first day you are sick. A doctor's note is required after three consecutive sick days.

Other leave types, such as bereavement or jury duty, are described in the country addenda.

Expenses

Submit expenses in Expensify within 30 days of the purchase. Attach a receipt for every expense above 25 USD. Expenses submitted after 60 days are not reimbursed without VP approval.

Meals while travelling are reimbursed up to 75 USD per day for domestic trips and 100 USD per day for international trips. Alcohol is not reimbursed unless it is part of an approved customer dinner.

Business Travel

All business trips need manager approval before booking. Book flights and hotels through Navan at least 14 days before departure when possible.

Book economy class for flights under 6 hours and premium economy for flights of 6 hours or longer. Hotels are capped at 250 USD per night, or 400 USD per night in New York, London, San Francisco and Tokyo.

Equipment

Every employee receives a MacBook Pro, which is refreshed every three years. Engineers may request an additional external monitor through the IT portal.

Remote and hybrid employees receive a one-time home office stipend of 500 USD and an internet allowance of 40 USD per month, paid through payroll.

Security Basics

Report a lost or stolen device to IT within one hour at it@acme.example, so the device can be locked and wiped. Never store customer data on personal devices or personal cloud accounts.

All employees complete security awareness training when they join and every year after that. Forward suspected phishing emails to phishing@acme.example instead of clicking links in them.

Learning and Growth

Each employee has a learning budget of 1,500 USD per year for courses, books and certifications. Conference trips are paid from the same budget, with travel booked under the travel policy.

Performance reviews happen twice a year, in April and October. Each review includes a self-assessment, peer feedback and a conversation with your manager about goals for the next six months.

Code of Conduct

Treat colleagues, customers and partners with respect. Harassment and discrimination are not tolerated. Report concerns to your manager, to People Operations, or anonymously through the ethics hotline at ethics.acme.example. Acme does not allow retaliation against anyone who reports a concern in good faith.